

Dress rehearsal for Test hopefuls as Team India targets continuity in selections

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The 2024 Duleep Trophy appeared to be heading for a predictable conclusion. Still, a last-minute twist saw Mayank Agarwal's India A claim the title by taking seven wickets in the final session to defeat India C.

India C needed 350 runs to win but a solitary point, which would be assured with a draw, was what it was really after. Sai Sudharsan and Ishan Kishan had guided India C through to tea and were on track to see the game out. However, India A's bowling attack dramatically changed the course of the match, securing a remarkable victory. India A also benefitted from India D's earlier win against India B, eliminating the latter from contention in a three-horse race.

In recent seasons, the Duleep Trophy has been reduced to a mere selection tournament for the Indian



team. The constant format changes have diminished the significance of winning the trophy. The traditional zonal format once offered bragging rights, but this year's shift to a mixed pool system kept the focus on individual performances.

Moreover, the teams were altered repeatedly, with players being added and removed at will. Ishan Kishan and Suryakumar Yadav, initially excluded due to injuries, were